

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 848

By McKenzie

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Randy Tyree of Knox County.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Randy Tyree of Knox County; and

WHEREAS, former Knoxville Mayor Randy Tyree lived a life marked by service to his family, community, and country, and he will be remembered for his kindness, humility, and sense of humor; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tyree was born in Gordonsville to a military and law enforcement family; he attended Gordonsville High School before moving to Washington, D.C., to work for the FBI, eventually transferring to Puerto Rico; and

WHEREAS, Randy Tyree resigned from the FBI to study at Middle Tennessee State University, graduating in 1965 and relocating to Knoxville to attend the University of Tennessee; shortly after arriving, he led an effort to honor the life of a pedestrian who died stopping a runaway truck, a compassionate gesture that garnered the attention of former Knoxville Mayor Leonard Rogers; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tyree went on to join the Knoxville Police Department, initially serving as a patrolman and then as a detective; his acumen and work ethic soon led to his promotion to the post of police and fire commissioner; and

WHEREAS, in 1969, Mr. Tyree began to work on the Tennessee Law Enforcement Planning Agency, where he served as the supervisor of judicial planning and eventually the assistant director; and

WHEREAS, the following year, Mayor Rogers appointed Randy Tyree as Knoxville's city safety director; under Mr. Tyree's leadership, Knoxville law enforcement carried out Operation Aquarius, a massive crackdown on illegal drugs in the State; and

WHEREAS, in 1972, Mr. Tyree joined the law firm of Egerton, Armistead, Davis, and McCord before moving to the firm of Morrison, Morrison, Tyree, and Morrow; and

WHEREAS, Randy Tyree announced that he was running for mayor in August 1975; at that time, he was chairman and president-elect of the Knox County Cancer Crusade and on the boards of the Knoxville Area Urban League, Consumer Credit Counseling Service, National Council of Christians and Jews, and Florence Crittenton Agency; and

WHEREAS, furthermore, Mr. Tyree served on the East Tennessee Law Enforcement Planning Commission's steering committee and the Knox County Alcohol and Drug Abuse Rehabilitation Advisory Committee; he was also a member of the Downtown Rotary Club and West Knoxville Jaycees, who named him Outstanding Young Man of the Year; and

WHEREAS, after being elected mayor in 1975, Randy Tyree most notably brought the World's Fair to Knoxville, something that many people said could not be done; he worked with U.S. Presidents Gerald Ford, Jimmy Carter, and Ronald Reagan to make it happen; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tyree stated about the fair that "it gave our community a purpose, and an attitude of being able to accomplish something beyond the ordinary [...] it unified the community in a way that I have not seen before or since"; and

WHEREAS, Randy Tyree served as mayor from 1976 to 1984; during his tenure, he helped bring more than 11 million visitors to the city; and

WHEREAS, in his later years, he worked for Visit Knoxville as an ambassador to the Sunsphere and became known as one of the best parts of the Sunsphere experience; and

WHEREAS, Randy Tyree will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his ex-wife and friend, Mary Pat Tyree; four children, Niki Tyree, Scott Tyree, Chad Tyree, and Ryan Tyree; daughter-in-law, JoElla Tyree; and grandchildren, Kaia and River; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tyree leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Randy Tyree, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Tyree.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.